

Highly Crucial Strait of Hormuz in the wake of US, Israel and Iran War

Introduction

"A 21-mile chokepoint holds the world's economy and its peace in a single, fragile grip."

Imagine waking up one morning to find that petrol has doubled in price overnight, flights have been cancelled, and supermarket shelves are half empty — not because of a local crisis, but because a narrow strip of water on the other side of the world has been blocked. This is not a scene from a movie. This is exactly what could happen if the Strait of Hormuz is ever closed. Located between Iran and Oman, this small but incredibly powerful waterway connects the oil-rich Persian Gulf to the rest of the world. Today, with tensions between the United States, Israel, and Iran reaching some of their highest points in modern history, the Strait of Hormuz has become the single most important and dangerous piece of water on Earth. Understanding why this strait matters so much — and what could happen if conflict breaks out around it — is one of the most important things any informed person can do today.

[Word count: ~150 words]

Body

Paragraph 1 — What is the Strait of Hormuz?

The Strait of Hormuz is a narrow strip of water that sits between Iran to the north and Oman and the United Arab Emirates to the south. At its narrowest point, it is only about 21 miles wide. Despite its small size, it is one of the most important places on Earth. It is the only sea passage connecting the Persian Gulf — home to the world's largest oil reserves — to the open ocean. Ships loaded with oil, gas, and goods must pass through this strait every single day to reach markets in Asia, Europe, and beyond. There is simply no other easy way out of the Gulf. Because of this, whoever controls or threatens the Strait of Hormuz holds enormous power over the entire global economy. It is not an exaggeration to call it the world's most important waterway.

[Paragraph word count: ~150 | Running total: ~300 words]

Paragraph 2 — Why is it so important for oil?

The numbers behind the Strait of Hormuz are truly staggering. Every single day, around 17 to 21 million barrels of oil pass through this strait. That is roughly 20 percent of all the oil traded in the

entire world. On top of that, about 25 percent of the world's liquefied natural gas also travels through the same narrow passage. Countries like Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Kuwait, the UAE, Bahrain, and Qatar all depend on this strait to export their energy to the world. If the strait were blocked even for a few days, global oil prices would shoot up dramatically. A longer blockage could push the world into a severe economic recession. Every time there is a military threat or incident near the Strait of Hormuz, oil prices on global markets jump immediately. This shows just how closely the world's economy is tied to this single, narrow waterway.

[Paragraph word count: ~155 | Running total: ~455 words]

Paragraph 3 — Iran's power over the strait

Iran is the country that sits on the northern shore of the Strait of Hormuz, and this gives it enormous strategic power. Iran's military has thousands of troops, missiles, naval vessels, submarines, and drones positioned along the coastline near the strait. Iranian leaders have repeatedly threatened to close the strait if the country is attacked or if oil sanctions are tightened. In fact, closing the strait has become one of Iran's most powerful cards in any confrontation with the West. Even the mere threat of closure is enough to shake global markets. Iran does not need to physically block every ship — it only needs to create enough fear and uncertainty to disrupt shipping. This is why, in any war scenario involving the US, Israel, and Iran, the Strait of Hormuz immediately becomes the most critical flashpoint. Iran knows that its control over this waterway gives it a form of power that no sanction can take away.

[Paragraph word count: ~160 | Running total: ~615 words]

Paragraph 4 — The US–Iran conflict background

The conflict between the United States and Iran did not begin recently. It has deep roots going back to the 1979 Islamic Revolution, when Iran's government became openly hostile to America. Over the decades, the US has imposed heavy economic sanctions on Iran, cutting off its access to international banking and trade. The two countries nearly went to war in January 2020, when the US assassinated Iran's top military commander, General Qasem Soleimani, in a drone strike. Iran responded with missile attacks on US bases in Iraq. The situation has remained tense ever since, especially over Iran's nuclear programme, which the US and its allies believe is aimed at producing a nuclear weapon. Every round of failed diplomacy or new sanction brings the two countries closer to the edge of direct conflict — and the Strait of Hormuz sits right at the centre of every threat and counter-threat.

[Paragraph word count: ~155 | Running total: ~770 words]

Paragraph 5 — Israel's role and Iran–Israel hostility

Israel's role in the tensions around the Strait of Hormuz is deeply significant. Israel and Iran consider each other direct enemies. Iran's leadership has repeatedly called for the destruction of Israel, while Israel views Iran's nuclear programme as an existential threat to its survival. Israel has conducted covert operations inside Iran, including the assassination of Iranian nuclear scientists and cyberattacks on Iranian nuclear facilities. In 2024, Iran directly launched drone and missile attacks on Israeli territory for the first time, and Israel responded with its own strikes inside Iran. If Israel were to launch a major military strike on Iran's nuclear sites, Iran would almost certainly respond by threatening or attacking shipping in the Strait of Hormuz. In this way, the Israeli-Iranian conflict does not stay limited to the two countries — it immediately puts the world's most important oil route in danger, pulling the US and the rest of the world into the crisis.

[Paragraph word count: ~160 | Running total: ~930 words]

Paragraph 6 — What if the strait is closed? The impact on oil prices

If the Strait of Hormuz were to be blocked or seriously disrupted by conflict, the effect on global oil prices would be immediate and severe. Analysts have estimated that oil prices could jump from around \$80 per barrel to over \$200 per barrel almost overnight. This would not just be a problem for stock markets and big companies. Ordinary people all over the world would feel the pain very quickly. Petrol prices at the pump would rise sharply. Electricity bills would increase because power stations also depend on gas and oil. The cost of transporting food, medicine, and goods would go up, meaning prices in shops would rise too. Airlines would struggle to afford fuel. Entire industries that depend on cheap energy would slow down or shut. In short, a disruption to the Strait of Hormuz would not stay in the Middle East — it would arrive at every household on the planet within weeks.

[Paragraph word count: ~160 | Running total: ~1090 words]

Paragraph 7 — Impact on Asian economies: China, India, and Japan

While the entire world would suffer if the Strait of Hormuz was closed, Asia would feel the impact most severely. China, the world's second-largest economy, imports a huge amount of its oil through this strait — sometimes over 80 percent of its total oil imports. India, which is one of the fastest-growing economies in the world, is also heavily dependent on Gulf oil that travels through the strait. Japan and South Korea import almost all of their oil through this passage. A closure would not just slow these economies — it could cause serious industrial shutdowns and public hardship. This is why China, India, Japan, and South Korea all pay extremely close attention to any military tensions near the strait. It also explains why these countries try to

maintain relationships with both sides of the conflict — with the US and with Iran — because their economic survival depends on this waterway staying open.

[Paragraph word count: ~155 | Running total: ~1245 words]

Paragraph 8 — US military presence in the Gulf

The United States has long understood the critical importance of the Strait of Hormuz and has positioned a massive military force in the region to protect it. The US Navy's Fifth Fleet is based in Bahrain and is specifically responsible for keeping the Persian Gulf and the strait safe for shipping. At any given time, the US has aircraft carriers, destroyers, submarines, and fighter jets ready to respond to any threat. The stated American policy is that the Strait of Hormuz must remain open to international shipping under all circumstances. When Iran has seized oil tankers or conducted threatening naval manoeuvres near the strait in recent years, the US military has responded by escorting ships and increasing its naval patrols. The presence of American military power in the Gulf is one of the main reasons the strait has not been formally closed so far — but it also means that any Iranian military action risks a direct confrontation with the world's most powerful military.

[Paragraph word count: ~160 | Running total: ~1405 words]

Paragraph 9 — Iran's asymmetric war tactics

One of the most important things to understand about the Strait of Hormuz situation is that Iran does not need to defeat the United States militarily in order to cause enormous damage. Iran uses what experts call asymmetric warfare — tactics designed to cause maximum disruption at minimum cost. These include deploying naval mines in the strait's shipping lanes, using small and fast speedboats to swarm larger vessels, firing anti-ship missiles from the coastline, and using armed drones to attack tankers and military ships. Iran does not need to sink an aircraft carrier. It only needs to make shipping companies and insurance firms too afraid to send their ships through the strait. Even if only a fraction of ships stop passing through, the effect on global oil supply would be massive. This is what makes the strait so dangerous — a small country with relatively limited military power can hold the entire world's energy supply at risk.

[Paragraph word count: ~158 | Running total: ~1563 words]

Paragraph 10 — Alternative routes and their limits

A natural question is: can the world not simply use another route if the Strait of Hormuz is blocked? The honest answer is — not really, at least not fully. There are some alternative

pipelines and routes. Saudi Arabia has a pipeline called the East-West Pipeline that can carry some oil across the Arabian Peninsula to the Red Sea, bypassing the strait. The UAE has also built a pipeline to its coastline outside the Gulf. However, these alternatives can only handle a fraction of the volume that currently passes through the Strait of Hormuz every day. There is simply no infrastructure in the world that can quickly replace 21 million barrels of oil per day flowing through a single passage. Building new pipelines takes years and costs billions of dollars. In a sudden crisis, the world would have no realistic alternative, which is why protecting the strait from conflict is so critically important.

[Paragraph word count: ~158 | Running total: ~1721 words]

Paragraph 11 — Diplomatic efforts and their fragility

Despite all the tensions, there have been efforts to resolve the underlying conflicts diplomatically. The original Iran nuclear deal, known as the JCPOA, was signed in 2015 and was meant to limit Iran's nuclear programme in exchange for lifting sanctions. However, the US withdrew from the deal in 2018 under President Trump, and Iran began expanding its nuclear activities again. Diplomatic talks have resumed at various points, but no solid new agreement has been reached. Meanwhile, regional dialogue between Iran and Saudi Arabia — two major rivals — has improved slightly in recent years, with China mediating between them. These small steps matter, because if Iran and its neighbours are talking, the chance of a sudden explosion of conflict decreases. However, all these diplomatic efforts remain fragile. One military strike, one assassinated official, or one seized oil tanker could collapse months of progress and push the region back to the edge of war.

[Paragraph word count: ~158 | Running total: ~1879 words]

Paragraph 12 — Pakistan and developing nations at risk

Countries like Pakistan, which are already under serious economic pressure, face a particularly painful vulnerability if the Strait of Hormuz is disrupted. Pakistan imports a significant portion of its oil and gas through this strait. A sharp rise in global oil prices would immediately increase the cost of fuel, electricity, and food in Pakistan — a burden that millions of ordinary citizens can barely afford to carry. Unlike wealthy countries, Pakistan does not have large strategic oil reserves that it can fall back on for months. The economic shock of a strait closure would hit Pakistani families directly and immediately. The same is true for dozens of other developing countries across South Asia, Southeast Asia, and Africa that depend on affordable Gulf energy. The Strait of Hormuz is not just a geopolitical problem for world powers — it is a daily bread-and-butter issue for billions of ordinary people around the world.

[Paragraph word count: ~155 | Running total: ~2034 words]

Conclusion

The Strait of Hormuz is not just a line on a map. It is the single most important pressure point in the modern world — a place where geography, military power, energy, and politics all come together in a way that affects every person on the planet. The growing conflict between the United States, Israel, and Iran has placed this small stretch of water under greater danger than at almost any other time in history. If the worst happens and the strait is blocked or becomes a battleground, the consequences will not stay in the Middle East. They will spread to every economy, every home, and every family on Earth. The world must therefore invest seriously in diplomacy, de-escalation, and finding alternative energy solutions. As long as the fate of billions of people depends on 21 miles of open water, that water must be protected — not by the barrel of a gun alone, but by wisdom, negotiation, and the courage to choose peace over war.